BAR FRANCO

Events pack · 2026

EVENTS WITH FLAVOUR. *Nights with feeling.*

166 Cashel St, Ōtautahi









01 · Benvenuti, welcome

FROM A TABLE FOR TWENTY TO THE WHOLE BUILDING.

Tell us the date. We'll handle the rest.

THE FOOD

Italian and house-made, pasta included, changing with the season.

THE ROOMS

A Negroni & Spritz Bar downstairs. An open-kitchen restaurant upstairs.

THE HOSTING

A dedicated team runs the night, from the first spritz to last drinks.

NO VENUE HIRE FEE.

You spend on food and drink, and that's it. Minimum spend on application.





02 · The spaces

TWO LEVELS. ONE WORLD.

Level 1 · downstairs

NEGRONI & SPRITZ BAR

Booths, high leaners and low tables around a lovely big bar. Sheer-draped windows, candlelight, and room for a DJ, a band and dancing.

Seated	80 · *more with hired-in furniture*
Standing	120

Level 2 · upstairs

THE RESTAURANT

The theatre of Italian cooking, straight from the open kitchen. Long tables, plus a private dining area at the far end.

Seated	90 · 120 *with hired-in furniture*
Standing	120

The spaces · at a glance

SPACES AT A GLANCE

Every space works for every kind of night. Every event is different, so we tailor everything to you.

Negroni & Spritz Bar	*80 seated, more with hired-in furniture · 120 standing*
The Restaurant	*90 seated, 120 with hired-in furniture · 120 standing*
The whole venue	*165 seated · 240 standing*
Private dining area	*Either level · by arrangement*
Group dining	*Either level · by arrangement*
Private lunches	*Either level · by arrangement*

Smaller groups · lunches

NOT A FUNCTION ROOM. A PLACE TO HOST.

For smaller groups, the bar or the private dining area in the Restaurant.

PRIVATE DINING AREA

A gorgeous table at the far end of the Restaurant, curtained off when you want it private.

GROUP DINING

Soak up the full buzz of the venue. We seat your group together, upstairs in the Restaurant or downstairs in the bar.

PRIVATE LUNCHES

Always available. A long, leisurely lunch, then afternoon drinks in town. Long, slow and very Italian.

The most-loved flow

THREE CHAPTERS INSTEAD OF ONE LONG SIT-DOWN.



Chapter 01

IN THE BAR

Welcome drinks and canapés in the Negroni & Spritz Bar.



Chapter 02

UPSTAIRS

A seated dinner in the Restaurant, with the open kitchen in full swing.



Chapter 03

BACK DOWN

Dessert and dancing. While you dine, we turn the bar into a dance floor.



03 · Food · we cook like someone's coming home

THREE WAYS TO FEED THE ROOM

Custom menus available · all prices exclude GST

01 · Standing

CANAPÉS

9/11
per piece

Passed on trays. Allow 4–6 pieces per guest.

Best for cocktail functions and after-work drinks.

02 · Seated

SHARED FRANCO

80
per person

Three courses down the middle of the table, served family-style.

Best for team dinners and long tables.

03 · The full evening

TUTTO FRANCO

110
per person

Shared Franco, plus a chef's-choice trio of canapés as guests arrive.

Best for end-of-year and client evenings.



C A N A P É S

Sample menu · changes with the season

Passed on trays. Allow 4–6 pieces per guest, or leave the choice to the chef.

BITES

9 each

Goats cheese croquettes, chilli honey – *V*
Seasonal arancini, pickled chilli,
parsley mayonnaise – *V · GFA · DFA*
Nonna's meatballs, tomato sugo,
parmesan, basil – *GFA · DFA*
Market fish crudo, orange,
Sicilian olive, lemon oil – *GF · DF*
Oysters, seasonal mignonette – *GF · DF*
Potatoes, parsley mayonnaise – *GF · DF*
Caprese skewer, bocconcini, tomato – *V · GF · DFA*
Melon, prosciutto – *GF · DF*

FOCACCIA SLIDERS

11 each

Mortadella, smoked provolone, rocket,
sugo, balsamic onions – *DFA · GFA*
Marinated eggplant, smoked provolone,
rocket, sugo, balsamic onions – *V · DFA · GFA*
Crostini, whipped ricotta, pickled tomatoes – *V*

PIADINI

11 each

Whipped ricotta, pesto, peperonata – *V · VA · GFA*
White anchovy, gremolata – *DF · GFA*
Prosciutto, stracciatella, rocket,
balsamic glaze – *DFA · GFA*

GRAZING TABLE

for the whole room

Per person … 40
Or a set amount … 1,000 · 1,500 · 2,000

V vegetarian · VA vegan available · GF gluten free · GFA gluten free available · DF dairy free · DFA dairy free available · all prices exclude GST



SHARED FRANCO

Sample menu · served family-style

Three courses down the middle of the table · 80pp

TO START

Focaccia

Antipasto misto, cured meats, marinated olives, roasted peppers, pickled onions – *GF · DF*

Stracciatella, peperonata, fig and pistachio agrodolce – *contains nuts*

MAINS

Pork ragù lasagne, rocket salad *(or seasonal risotto) – GFA · DFA*

Porchetta, cannellini purée, gremolata *(or eggplant involtini, dairy-free ricotta) – GFA · DFA · VA*

Patate arrosto, parsley mayo – *GF · DF*

Fennel and citrus salad, mint, chilli – *GF · DF · V*

DOLCI

Tiramisu

Strawberry sorbet – *DF · V*

TUTTO FRANCO

The full evening

Shared Franco, plus a chef's-choice trio of canapés as guests arrive · 110pp

ON ARRIVAL

A chef's-choice trio from the canapés list, passed as guests arrive

AT THE TABLE

Focaccia · Antipasto misto · Stracciatella, peperonata, fig and pistachio agrodolce

Pork ragù lasagne · Porchetta · Patate arrosto · Fennel and citrus salad

TO FINISH

Tiramisu · Strawberry sorbet

Vegetarian and dairy-free swaps are built in. All prices exclude GST.



Dietaries · custom menus

NO ONE GOES HUNGRY AT BAR FRANCO.

EVERY DIETARY

Coeliac, vegan, allergies: all of them. Send the list with guest names alongside your final numbers. Each guest gets their own labelled plate and a check-in from the team.

CUSTOM MENUS

For food and drinks. Tell us what you have in mind and we'll build it. Anything we order in specially is charged in full, for the whole amount ordered.

SERVED TO SHARE

For groups, everything is served to share and arranged ahead, so everyone eats together and the night flows. Food isn't ordered on the night.

THE LITTLE THINGS

Pasta, arancini, meatballs or pizza for little ones. Leftovers packed to take home. Printed menus with your logo or a custom heading.

V vegetarian · VA vegan available · GF gluten free · GFA gluten free available · DF dairy free · DFA dairy free available

Nuts in the stracciatella (pistachio agrodolce) · egg in the parsley mayo, left out on request · gluten-free swaps are confirmed with the kitchen before service.



04 · Drinks · charged on consumption

IT STARTS WITH A NEGRONI.

ON CONSUMPTION

You pay for what's poured. No packages, no subsidised drinks, and no BYO.

THE BAR TAB

Choose 6 wines, 6 cocktails, 4 beers and 4 non-alcoholic drinks. Spirits and mixers are your call.

CASH BAR, TOO

Run a tab with a limit, a cash bar, or both. We keep you posted on the spend all night.

WELCOME DRINK

Required for 30 guests or more, so no one queues at the bar. The Aperol Spritz rarely loses.

MAKE IT YOURS

A house cocktail renamed after you, an Aperol or champagne tower, or bubbles poured and waiting.

THE BAR LIST

Drinks · pick your tab from here

Choose 6 wines, 6 cocktails, 4 beers and 4 non-alcoholic drinks.
Spirits and mixers are your call. Charged on consumption.

APERITIVO

Aperol Spritz – *Aperol, Prosecco, Soda* 23
Campari Spritz – *Campari, Prosecco, Soda* 23
Limoncello Spritz – *Santa Marta Limoncello, Prosecco, Soda* 23
Hugo Spritz – *Fiorente Elderflower, Prosecco, Soda* 23
Classic Negroni – *Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Bulldog Gin* 24
Negroni Sbagliato – *Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Prosecco* 23
Cherry Negroni – *Campari, Cherry, Rosso Vermouth, Bulldog Gin* 25
Americano – *Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Soda* 24
Amaretto Sour – *Disaronno, Wild Turkey Bourbon, Egg White, Lemon* 25
Franco Margarita – *Espolon Tequila, Grand Marnier, Lemon* 24
Espresso Martini – *Skyy Vodka, Tia Maria, Espresso* 25
Boulevardier – *Campari, Rosso Vermouth, Wild Turkey Bourbon* 26
Olio Martini: Dry or Dirty – *Vodka or Gin, Vermouth, Olives* 25

BIRRA

Peroni – *Tap* 15
Peroni – *0%* 12
BRB Pilsner 15
Menabrea Bionda 17
Menabrea Zero Zero 17

NON-ALC

Sanpellegrino Italian sparkling

Limonata 15
Aranciata 15
Aranciata Rossa 15
Pompelmo 15





V I N O

Drinks · the wine list

Eight wines pour by the glass on the night; the rest are bottle-only, made for the table. Prices are per bottle.

VINO SPUMANTE

Tallero Prosecco Extra Dry – *Veneto* 90
Ferrari Brut Trento DOC – *Trentino* 140
Laurent-Perrier La Cuvée Brut NV – *Champagne* 165

VINO BIANCO

Mezzacorona Castel Firmian Sauvignon Blanc – *Trentino* 95
Fantini Primo Malvasia Chardonnay – *Abruzzo* 85
Vigneti Romio Pinot Grigio – *Friuli* 95
Vesevo Beneventano Falanghina IGT – *Campania* 90
Pipoli Bianco Basilicata IGT – *Basilicata* 110
Mahi Sauvignon Blanc 2025 – *Marlborough* 85
Dog Point Chardonnay 2023 – *Marlborough* 120

VINO ROSATO

Fattoria di Basciano Rosato – *Toscana* 90

VINO ROSSO

Renzo Masi Chianti Cornioletta – *Toscana* 95
Fantini Montepulciano – *Abruzzo* 90
Vigneti Romio Organic Sangiovese Rubicone – *Emilia-Romagna* 85
Sallier de la Tour Syrah – *Sicilia* 95
Atzei Saragat Cannonau di Sardegna – *Sardegna* 100
Ascheri Langhe Nebbiolo San Giacomo – *Piemonte* 110
Vanita Primitivo di Manduria DOP – *Puglia* 93
Fattoria di Basciano Chianti Rufina Riserva – *Toscana* 107
Dicey Bannockburn Pinot Noir 2022 – *Central Otago* 110

05 · Pricing · all prices exclude GST

MINIMUM SPEND

On application, set by the night and the space.

Private lunches	*on request*

No venue hire fee, and all of this

THE ROOM IS YOURS.

INCLUDED

- Set-up and pack-down
- A dedicated team: one server per 10 guests, plus a manager
- Candlelight, low lighting and olive branches
- Personalised menus, with your logo if you like
- Your décor, name cards and seating plan, set out by us
- Projector, screen and handheld microphone
- Our sound system, for your playlist, DJ or band

EXTRAS

Cakeage	50
Security for 18ths and 21sts	*at cost*
Linen hire	25 a cloth
Grazing table	from 40 pp
Bigger AV set-ups	*quoted*

Security is quoted in your proposal. Bigger AV goes through our AV partner. Linen is hired in for you.

Deposits and payments

SECURING YOUR DATE

We pencil your date in while you decide. It goes to whoever confirms first.

TO CONFIRM

A non-refundable deposit, taken off your drinks bill.

Spend under 7,000	500 + GST
7,000 to 10,000	1,000 + GST
Over 10,000	1,500 + GST

IF PLANS CHANGE

Full terms are in our Venue Hire Agreement.

30+ days out	*we keep the deposit*
14–30 days out	50% *of your quote*
Under 14 days	100% *of your quote*

5 DAYS BEFORE

Final numbers and dietaries are due, and we invoice your food on those numbers. Late additions are welcome; numbers can't go down.

ON THE NIGHT

Drinks are settled at the end of the night, or invoiced after the event, less your deposit.





06 · From first email to last drinks

HOW IT WORKS

01 TELL US ABOUT THE NIGHT

The date, how many, seated or standing, and a rough budget. If it's a milestone, say so.

02 WE CALL, THEN PROPOSE

A quick chat first. Then the right space, your quote and menu ideas in writing, with your date pencilled in.

03 COME IN

Any day from 3:30pm, for a drink on us and a walk through both levels.

04 LOCK IT IN

A deposit secures the date. First to confirm gets it.

05 SHAPE THE DETAILS

A few weeks out, one simple checklist: food, drinks, numbers, dietaries, timings, music, AV, décor and cake.

06 SIGN OFF YOUR RUNSHEET

Final numbers and dietaries are due five days out, and we invoice your food then.

07 WE HOST. YOU STAY.

From the first spritz to last drinks, our team runs the night so you can be in the room.

START HERE

Send us the date and the numbers · events@barfranco.nz · 021 221 1307

07 · Good to know

PLANNING NOTES

ACCESS

Someone's on site from 3:30pm every day. Decorations, flowers and cake arrive from 3:30pm on the day. Earlier set-up or suppliers by arrangement.

CAKE

Cakeage is $50, and our chefs slice and serve it on platters (allow about 30 minutes). Bring your own candles. There's no fridge space the day before.

AV

A handheld mic, projector and screen, at no charge (there's no TV). Bring a laptop and HDMI cable, or send the file ahead. Bigger set-ups go through our AV partner.

DECORATIONS

Balloons, flowers, signage, banners and photo booths are all welcome. Vinyl stickers must peel off cleanly. Sharing plates leave little room for big centrepieces.

MUSIC

Our playlist, your Spotify over Bluetooth, or a DJ, duo or band on our sound system.

GETTING HERE

166 Cashel Street, The Crossing.
Take the lift near H&M and Coffee Culture, or the stairs. The Crossing carpark is right there. On request, we'll sign the lift and greet guests at the door.



House rules

THE FINE PRINT

18THS AND 21STS

We host them, a little differently. A security guard is required, charged at cost. Over-18s wear wristbands, which you supply, and ID is checked at the door.

CHILDREN

Under-18s are welcome at private events, with a parent or legal guardian beside them.

TIMINGS

Last drinks at 11:30pm, doors close at midnight. Until then, the night is yours.

CHRISTMAS

We keep it Italian. December books out fast, so enquire early. We're closed from 24 December to 5 January.

GST

All prices exclude GST.

08 · Suppliers we love

FRIENDS OF FRANCO

Bring your own, or lean on the people we already work with.

Flowers	*A Little Bit Floral · Tholsie & Co*
Cakes	*Full Time Tart*
Live music	*Vintage Blue*
Backdrops	*Blank Space Events*
AV	*Shipleys*
Security	*October Protection*
Stay nearby	*BreakFree on Cashel · The Observatory · Crowne Plaza*



Ti aspettiamo, we're waiting for you

SEND US THE DATE AND THE NUMBERS.

Jenna's in Monday, Wednesday and Friday. Can't reach her? Ana-Maria will come straight back to you.

JENNA · EVENTS MANAGER

Monday, Wednesday and Friday

events@barfranco.nz

021 221 1307

ANA-MARIA · OWNER

Any other day, or if Jenna's away

anamaria@barfranco.nz

FIND US

(upstairs) The Crossing

166 Cashel Street, Christchurch.

Lift near H&M and KOOKAÏ.

COME IN

Any day from 3:30pm

For a drink on us and a walk through both levels.